the *New York Times* said of India's rules, 'that has meant that a tiny tweak in the synthesis of a molecule yields a new patent. Several companies can produce the same drug, creating competition that drives down prices.' According to the newspaper, India's colonial era patent laws had resulted in some of the world's highest drug prices whereas process patents on drugs, fertilizers and pesticides helped extend life expectancy and ended regular famines. In Africa, for example, Indian-made drugs helped drive the annual price of antiretroviral treatment needed for AIDS patients down from $15,000 per patient to about $200.[27]

By insisting on an exception to WTO rules on Intellectual Property Rights, India was able to build a successful pharmaceutical industry that manufactured drugs patented in the West using a different process than the patent holder. Once the Indian pharmaceutical industry was able to benefit from having both process and product patents, India changed its position. It now recognizes the WTO's patent rules, after having fought for distinction between product and process patent for years.

A similar economic nationalism can be seen in India's stance at the Doha round of WTO trade negotiations, where India seeks an exception for agricultural subsidies and policies regarding government storage, pricing and distribution of foodgrains. Behind India's difficult bargaining at WTO lies the belief that India is different, unique and sufficiently important for the rest of the world to accept its demands for exceptions. India's stubborn insistence on being granted an exception at every international venue creates the risk of India being left out of global trade arrangements in addition to the potential for countries like the United States simply walking away from international negotiations held up by India. A better policy for India might be based on give and take to ensure inclusion alongside the US and Europe, something that India appears to have done in relation to the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCC), by signing it to coincide with Mahatma Gandhi's Birthday on 2 October 2016.